

# NEXUS Playbook

## ClearGlassCorp NEXUS — Enterprise Enhancement

NEXUS is a practical operating system for scale. It installs structure that reduces chaos, improves throughput, and creates accountability you can measure.

**Truth:** Most businesses don't have a "people problem." They have a **system problem** that creates people problems.

## The NEXUS framework

NEXUS has five modules. Install them in order. Each one reinforces the next.

| Module               | Purpose                                                    | Output                                     |
|----------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------|
| 1) Clarity           | Define roles, decision lanes, and what "good" looks like.  | Owners + responsibilities + decision rules |
| 2) Cadence           | Create a predictable operating rhythm and reporting cycle. | Weekly meeting structure + reporting       |
| 3) Standardization   | Turn recurring work into repeatable process.               | SOPs for critical workflows                |
| 4) Measurement       | Choose a small set of KPIs that drive behavior.            | Scorecard + weekly review                  |
| 5) Automation + Risk | Automate friction points and reduce operational risk.      | Automation map + risk controls             |

## Core principles

- **Fewer metrics, more action.** If it can't be reviewed weekly, it's not a KPI.
- **One owner per outcome.** Shared ownership is usually disguised avoidance.
- **Documentation is a weapon.** If knowledge lives in someone's head, your business is fragile.
- **Cadence creates calm.** Predictable rhythm prevents panic-driven decisions.
- **Automation follows standardization.** Don't automate chaos.

# Module 1 — Clarity

Install ownership, decision lanes, and what “good” means.

## Outputs

- Role map: who owns what outcomes
- Decision lanes: what decisions live where
- Definition of Done (DoD): what acceptable quality looks like

## Quick implementation

- List your top 10 recurring decisions (pricing, refunds, hiring, approvals, etc.).
- Assign a decision lane: **Decide, Recommend, Consult, Inform.**
- Publish a 1-page “Who decides what” sheet to the team.
- Write 3 Definitions of Done for your most critical deliverables.

**Failure signal:** decisions get escalated to the top because there is no agreed lane.

## Module 2 — Cadence

Build a predictable rhythm so problems surface early and work stays aligned.

### Recommended weekly cadence

| Meeting                  | Frequency | Duration  | Purpose                                   |
|--------------------------|-----------|-----------|-------------------------------------------|
| Weekly Ops Review        | Weekly    | 45–60 min | Review scorecard, unblock, assign actions |
| Pipeline / Demand Review | Weekly    | 30 min    | Forecast work and revenue drivers         |
| Quality + Risk Review    | Bi-weekly | 30 min    | Defects, incidents, prevention actions    |
| Leadership Decisions     | Weekly    | 30 min    | High-impact decisions with clear owners   |

### Rules that keep cadence from becoming theater

- No agenda = no meeting.
- Numbers first, stories second.
- Actions must have: owner, due date, and measurable outcome.
- If it doesn't move a KPI or remove a blocker, it's noise.

## Module 3 — Standardization

Turn repeating work into repeatable process so quality is consistent and onboarding is fast.

### Choose the first 3 SOPs

- Pick workflows that happen weekly and create mistakes or delays.
- Start with the biggest handoffs (sales to delivery, delivery to billing, support to ops).
- Aim for **2–4 pages** per SOP. Clear beats comprehensive.

### SOP minimum standard

- Purpose + trigger
- Inputs (what must exist before starting)
- Steps (numbered, with role owner per step)
- Quality checks + Definition of Done
- Escalation rules

**Failure signal:** SOPs exist but aren't used. Fix by linking SOP usage to weekly review and training.

## Module 4 — Measurement

Pick a scorecard that drives behavior weekly. Keep it small so it gets used.

### Scorecard categories

- **Throughput:** work completed, cycle time, on-time delivery
- **Quality:** defects, rework, customer complaints
- **Reliability:** incidents, missed SLAs, backlog age
- **Cash:** revenue, margin, AR aging (if relevant)

### KPI selection rules

- Choose 1–2 KPIs per category (max 8 total).
- Each KPI must have: owner, target, and action when off-track.
- Review weekly. Update targets quarterly.

## Module 5 — Automation + Risk

After standardization, automate the highest-friction steps and reduce avoidable risk.

### Automation triage

- Automate **handoffs** (status updates, approvals, routing).
- Automate **data capture** (forms into systems, logging).
- Automate **notifications** (deadlines, SLA breaches, exceptions).

### Risk controls that pay for themselves

- Single source of truth for work tracking (one system, not 5).
- Access control and role-based permissions.
- Incident log + root cause review (monthly).
- Backups and recovery steps documented.

### The NEXUS install checklist (summary)

- Run Diagnostic, choose top 3 problems
- Assign owners and decision lanes
- Install weekly cadence + scorecard
- Write 3 SOPs for critical workflows
- Automate 1 high-friction handoff
- Review weekly, improve monthly